Practice workbook · Quality, quality control and competitive advantage

Quality control, total quality management, why quality matters for goods and services, and how quality and other strengths give competitive advantage.

17 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 16 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: BUS-S5-14

1. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2023 NOV · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part e only.

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2 *Kraft Heinz* has different functional areas within the business. These functional areas work together to ensure that *Kraft Heinz* maintains high standards of production with limited waste material.

Kraft Heinz aims to be involved in the local area through various methods such as charity and sporting events.

(a) State **one** task that human resources would carry out at *Kraft Heinz* when recruiting an employee.

(1)

(b) State **one** financial objective *Kraft Heinz* might have.

(1)

(c) Explain **one** reason why some businesses use crowdfunding as a source of finance.

(3)

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1. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2023 NOV · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part e only.

(d) Explain **one** disadvantage to a business of using retained profits to purchase goods and services.

(3)

(e) Explain **one** reason why the quality of goods manufactured by a business is important to its success.

(3)

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1. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2023 NOV · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part e only.

Kraft Heinz constantly aims to promote its products to encourage people to increase sales. To do this *Kraft Heinz* is considering using the following techniques:

Option 1: sponsorship of a local charity

Option 2: increasing the number of special offers.

(f) Justify which **one** of these two options *Kraft Heinz* should choose.

(9)

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1. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 2 · part a · 1 mark

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

2 (a) State **one** reason why *Artify Studio* would want to offer a high-quality service.

(1)

(b) State **one** advantage for *Artify* Studio of using part-time employees.

(1)

(c) Explain **one** benefit to a business of being a partnership.

(3)

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2. Question 2 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

2 During the preparation of food, the chefs at *Can Culleretes* have to follow health and safety regulations. New regulations are made from time to time.

(a) State **one** impact government legislation could have on *Can Culleretes*.

(1)

(b) State **one** way *Can Culleretes* might add value to its business.

(1)

(c) Explain **one** method a business could use to encourage repeat purchase of its products.

(3)

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3. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 1 · part d · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part d only.

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1 *The Better Toy Store (TBTS)* is a children's toy shop. *TBTS* has three shops in Singapore. Two of the shops are located in busy shopping malls and the third is located at the Jewel Changi Airport. *TBTS* has a website for customers looking to buy toys online.

TBTS selects toys to sell that are excellent for play, value, design and quality. All *TBTS* toys are environmentally friendly.

(a) (i) Which **one** of the following is a form of promotion that targets a specialised segment of the market?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** Mass marketing
- ☒ **B** Niche marketing
- ☒ **C** Market share
- ☒ **D** Market analysis

(ii) Which **one** of the following is a financial aim for a business?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** Survival
- ☒ **B** Challenge
- ☒ **C** Social objectives
- ☒ **D** Personal satisfaction

(iii) Which **one** of the following is a variable cost?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** Rent paid
- ☒ **B** Management salaries
- ☒ **C** Insurance agreed
- ☒ **D** Raw materials

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4. Question 1 · part d · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part d only.

(iv) Which **one** of the following is a role of the production function?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** Workforce planning
- ☒ **B** Quality control
- ☒ **C** Customer service
- ☒ **D** Staff welfare

TBTS buys its balloon packs from a local supplier for 7.20 Singapore Dollars (SGD) a pack. It sells them to customers for 16.90 SGD.

(v) Which **one** of the following is the markup on a pack of balloons?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** 7.20 %
- ☒ **B** 9.70 %
- ☒ **C** 69.84 %
- ☒ **D** 134.72 %

TBTS sells balloons in packs of four at a price of 67.60 SGD.
The exchange rate is 1 SGD = 3.05 Malaysian Ringgit (MYR).

(vi) Which **one** of the following would a customer in Malaysia pay in MYR for 4 balloon packs?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** 16.90 MYR
- ☒ **B** 22.16 MYR
- ☒ **C** 67.60 MYR
- ☒ **D** 206.18 MYR

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4. Question 1 · part d · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part d only.

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(b) Define the term **primary sector**.

(1)

(c) Define the term **diseconomies of scale**.

(1)

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(d) State **one** factor *TBTS* should consider when selecting its manufacturers.

(1)

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Figure 1 is a financial extract from *TBTS* based on the sale of 160 wooden toy carts.

	SGD
Variable costs per unit	0.93
Fixed costs	555.31

Figure 1

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(e) Calculate the total costs for *TBTS* of making 160 wooden toy carts. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

SGD

4. Question 1 · part d · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 1 · part c · 1 mark

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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1 *IKEA* is a well-known home furniture retailer with stores throughout the world. It was started in 1943 by Ingvar Kamprad when he was given some money by his father for doing well at school. He wanted to produce furniture at a price that people could afford to buy.

He realised that transporting furniture to customers was difficult as goods were often damaged. He developed flat packs to avoid damage. A flat pack contained all the materials needed to self-assemble a table, a chair or a bed.

All *IKEA* stores are run as franchises.

(a) (i) Which **one** of the following is a financial business objective?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** Challenge
- ☒ **B** Social objectives
- ☒ **C** Survival
- ☒ **D** Personal satisfaction

(ii) Which **one** of the following is an advantage to a business of using venture capital?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** It decreases access to other sources of finance
- ☒ **B** It keeps ownership in the business
- ☒ **C** It improves public relations
- ☒ **D** It can receive expert advice

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5. Question 1 · part c · 1 mark

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

A Canadian supplier of timber charges *IKEA* $19.75 Canadian Dollars (CAD) per load.

The exchange rate is $1 CAD = 6.58 Swedish Krona (SEK).

(iii) Which **one** of the following would be the cost to *IKEA* for 1,000 loads in Swedish Krona?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** 151.98 SEK
- ☒ **B** 3 001.52 SEK
- ☒ **C** 19 750.00 SEK
- ☒ **D** 129 955.00 SEK

An *IKEA* dining table costs *IKEA* 3 800 SEK to make. The table sells for 4 400 SEK.

(iv) Which **one** of the following is the correct markup?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** 1.16%
- ☒ **B** 13.64%
- ☒ **C** 15.79%
- ☒ **D** 115.79%

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5. Question 1 · part c · 1 mark

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Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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Figure 1 is a diagram of a product life cycle.

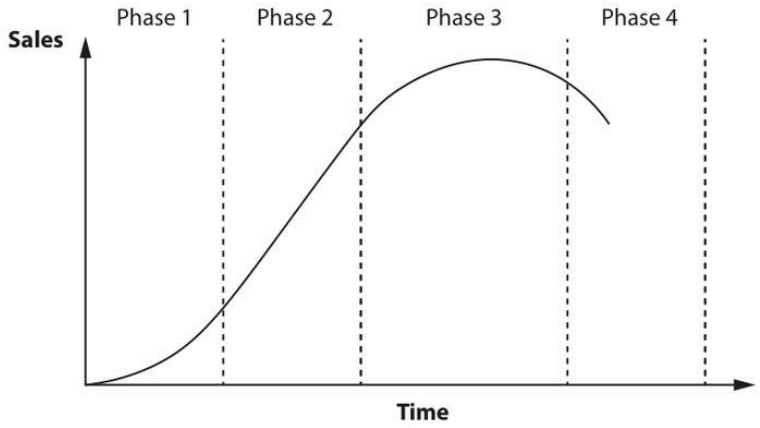


Figure 1

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(v) Which **one** of the following is Phase 3 of the product life cycle?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** Decline
- ☒ **B** Growth
- ☒ **C** Introduction
- ☒ **D** Maturity

(vi) Which **one** of the following are equal in a break-even graph?

Select **one** answer.

(1)

- ☒ **A** Fixed costs and variable costs
- ☒ **B** Fixed costs and revenue
- ☒ **C** Total costs and fixed costs
- ☒ **D** Total costs and revenue

5. Question 1 · part c · 1 mark

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

(b) Define the term **person specification**.

(1)

(c) Define the term **quality control**.

(1)

(d) State **one** reason why *IKEA* provides induction training for new employees.

(1)

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Figure 2 is an extract from *IKEA*'s Statement of Income for 2020.

	Euros (€) millions
Revenue	37 368
Cost of sales and services	25 643
Gross profit	11 725

Figure 2

(e) Calculate, to two decimal places, the gross profit margin for 2020. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

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5. Question 1 · part c · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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6. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark

2025 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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2 (a) State **one** reason why *Samsung* may need long-term finance.

(1)

(b) State **one** reason why quality control is a benefit to *Samsung*.

(1)

(c) Explain **one** advantage to a business of having a social objective.

(3)

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6. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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7. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part e only.

2 (a) State **one** reason why *Artify Studio* would want to offer a high-quality service.

(1)

(b) State **one** advantage for *Artify* Studio of using part-time employees.

(1)

(c) Explain **one** benefit to a business of being a partnership.

(3)

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7. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part e only.

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(d) Explain **one** way social media can be used by a business.

(3)

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(e) Explain **one** benefit for a business from the introduction of total quality management (TQM).

(3)

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7. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part e only.

Artify Studio has decided to use public relations to improve its image.

It is considering two options:

Option 1: sponsoring a local art show in the Kampong Glam area

Option 2: having a stand at a national art exhibition in Singapore's capital.

(f) Justify which **one** of these two options *Artify Studio* should choose.

(9)

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7. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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8. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part e only.

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2 *M&M* is constantly working to maintain the standards and quality of its products.

(a) State **one** non-financial objective for *M&M*.

(1)

(b) State **one** reason why *M&M* could dismiss an employee.

(1)

(c) Explain **one** reason why branding is important to businesses.

(3)

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8. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part e only.

(d) Explain **one** way businesses ensure that all employees have equal opportunities.

(3)

(e) Explain **one** reason why businesses maintain the quality of their products.

(3)

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8. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part e only.

M&M wants to remain the world's largest manufacturers of cars, vans and tractors. To do this it is always introducing new ways of keeping its customers interested. *M&M* is considering the following options.

Option 1: increase promotion of all vehicles

Option 2: make improvements to all vehicles.

(f) Justify which **one** of these two options *M&M* should choose.

(9)

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8. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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9. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part e only.

2 (a) State **one** financial method of motivation *CCT* could use with its employees.

(1)

(b) State **one** benefit to *CCT* of satisfying customer needs.

(1)

(c) Explain **one** way a business could increase its profit.

(3)

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9. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part e only.

(d) Explain **one** way that the introduction of tariffs might affect a business importing goods.

(3)

(e) Explain **one** reason why quality control is important to a business.

(3)

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9. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part e only.

The owner of *CCT* wants to measure the success of the business.

The owner is considering two options:

Option 1: customer satisfaction

Option 2: profit.

(f) Justify which **one** of these two options the owner of *CCT* should choose.

(9)

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9. Question 2 · part e · 3 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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10. Question 2 · part c · 3 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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2 (a) State **one** factor *Four Fitness* may consider when choosing a location for its new gym.

(1)

(b) State **one** reason why branding is important to *Four Fitness*.

(1)

(c) Explain **one** advantage to a business of using total quality management.

(3)

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10. Question 2 · part c · 3 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

(d) Explain **one** problem a business might face as a result of ineffective communication.

(3)

(e) Explain **one** disadvantage to a small business of borrowing money from a bank.

(3)

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10. Question 2 · part c · 3 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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11. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

4 *Huawei* has to maintain the quality of its products to be able to compete with other businesses, as well as generating profit. It must also ensure that the products it produces meet the needs of its customers as well as introducing new and different forms of technology. On its website it states '*Huawei* are committed to bringing digital to every person, home and organisation for a fully connected, intelligent world'.

In January 2019 *Huawei* launched the *Huawei* 10 Pro smartphone in the US at a cost of 5 353 Renminbi (CNY).

The exchange rate was $1 = 6.70 CNY (Chinese Yuan Renminbi)

(a) Calculate the cost of this smartphone in US Dollars. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

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11. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(b) Analyse why *Huawei* would want good quality control when producing its smartphones.

(6)

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11. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(c) Evaluate why *Huawei* would carry out market research before designing a new product. You should use the information provided as well as your own knowledge of business.

(12)

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11. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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12. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

4 In 2022 the current assets for *Premier Inn* were £9 566 million and current liabilities were £5 447 million.

(a) Calculate, to two decimal places, the current ratio in 2022. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

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12. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Analyse the importance of making sure that guests have a quality service when staying at a *Premier Inn*.

(6)

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12. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(c) Evaluate why a business such as *Premier Inn* would only consider profit to measure its success. You should use the information provided as well as your own knowledge of business.

(12)

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12. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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13. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2021 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

4 *NEXT* continually monitors progress so that it can measure the success of its business. It aims to do this through improving manufacturing techniques and cutting costs, whilst still maintaining the quality of the goods produced.

Figure 2 shows selected financial information for *NEXT* in 2019.

	2019 (£m)
Revenue	4 221
Operating profit	590

Figure 2

(a) Calculate to two decimal places the operating profit margin for *NEXT* in 2019. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

.....%

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13. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2021 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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(b) Analyse the effects for *NEXT* of an increase in UK interest rates.

(6)

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13. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2021 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

(c) Evaluate the importance for *NEXT* of maintaining quality throughout all of its manufacturing processes. You should use the information provided as well as your own knowledge of business.

(12)

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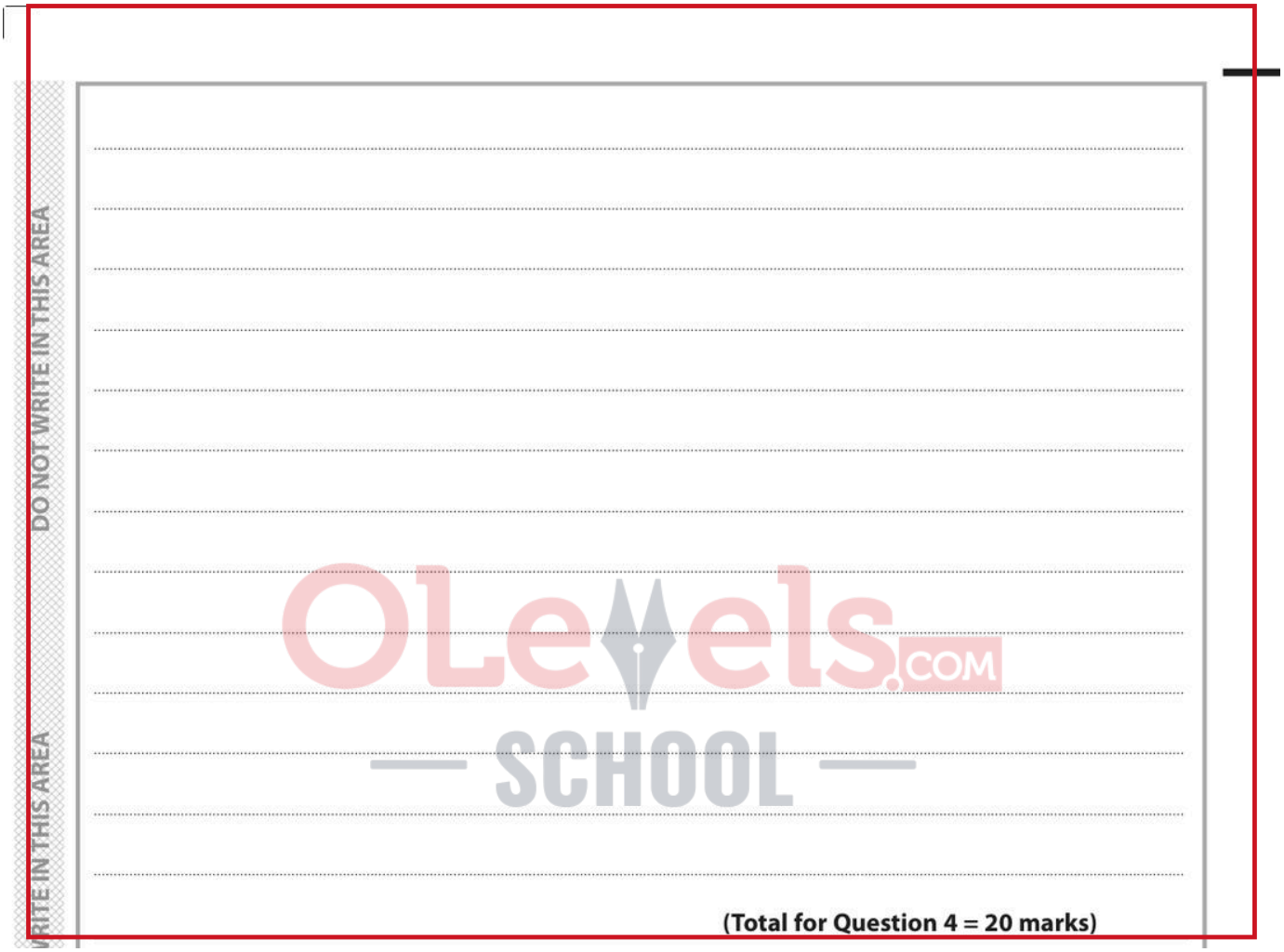
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13. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2021 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.



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13. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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14. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

4 **Figure 2** shows the total cost to *TUI* of employees' salaries.

Total cost of employees	€ '000
2021	39 631
2022	57 498

Figure 2

(a) Calculate, to two decimal places, the percentage increase in the total cost of employees from 2021 to 2022. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

.....%

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14. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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(b) Analyse how *TUI* could make use of the Boston Matrix to review all the different types of holidays it offers.

(6)

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14. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

(c) Evaluate the benefits for *TUI* of providing a quality service. You should use the information provided as well as your own knowledge of business.

(12)

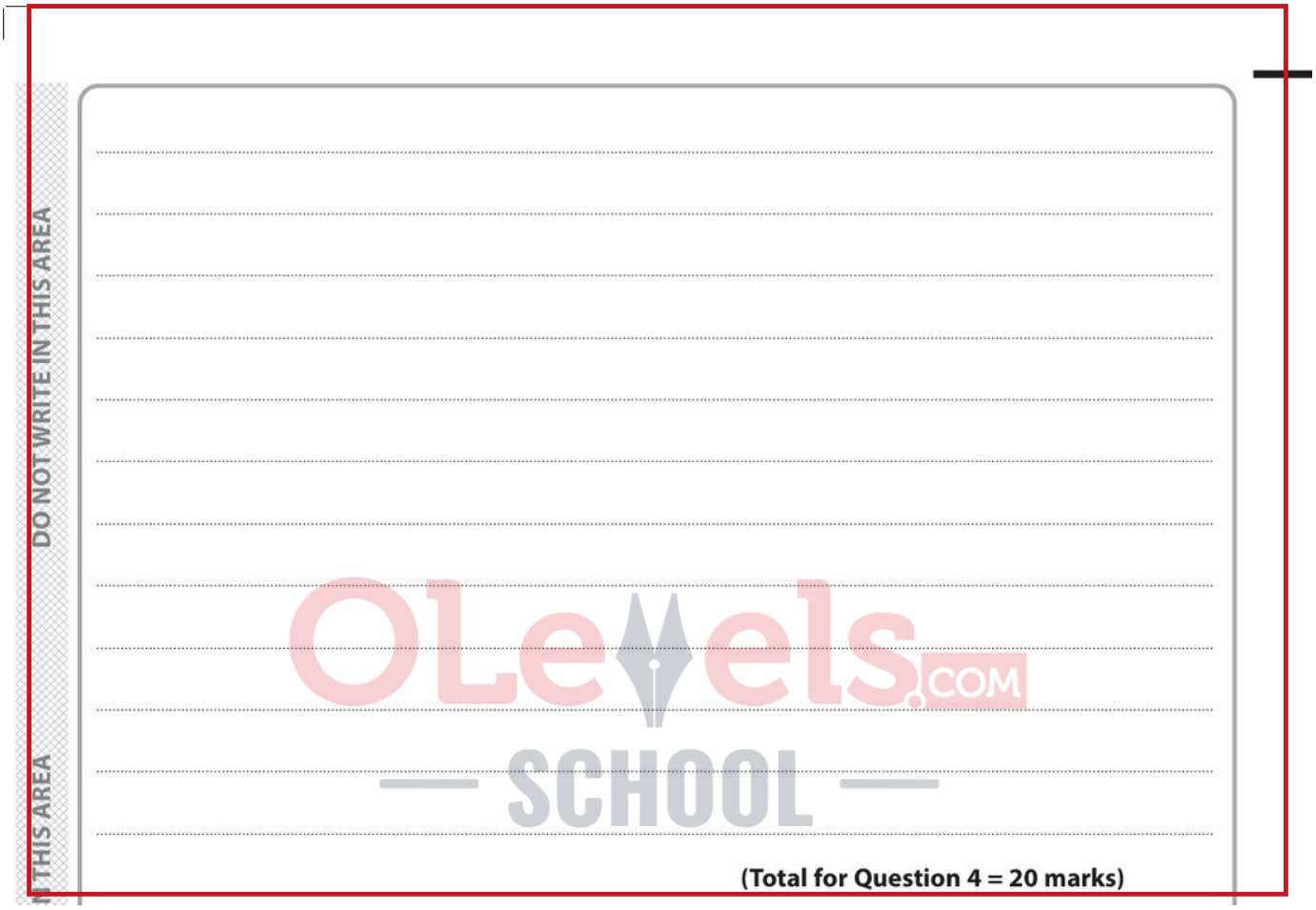
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14. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part c only.



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14. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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15. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

4 **Figure 3** is an extract from *Saha*'s statement of financial position.

	TRY (million)
Current assets	12
Inventory	4
Current liabilities	7

Figure 3

(a) Calculate, to two decimal places, the acid test ratio for *Saha*. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

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15. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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(b) Analyse the benefits for *Saha* of becoming a multinational business.

(6)

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15. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

Saha aims to manufacture robots that are high quality and long lasting.

(c) Evaluate the effects on *Saha* of introducing total quality management (TQM) to its business. You should use the information provided as well as your own knowledge of business.

(12)

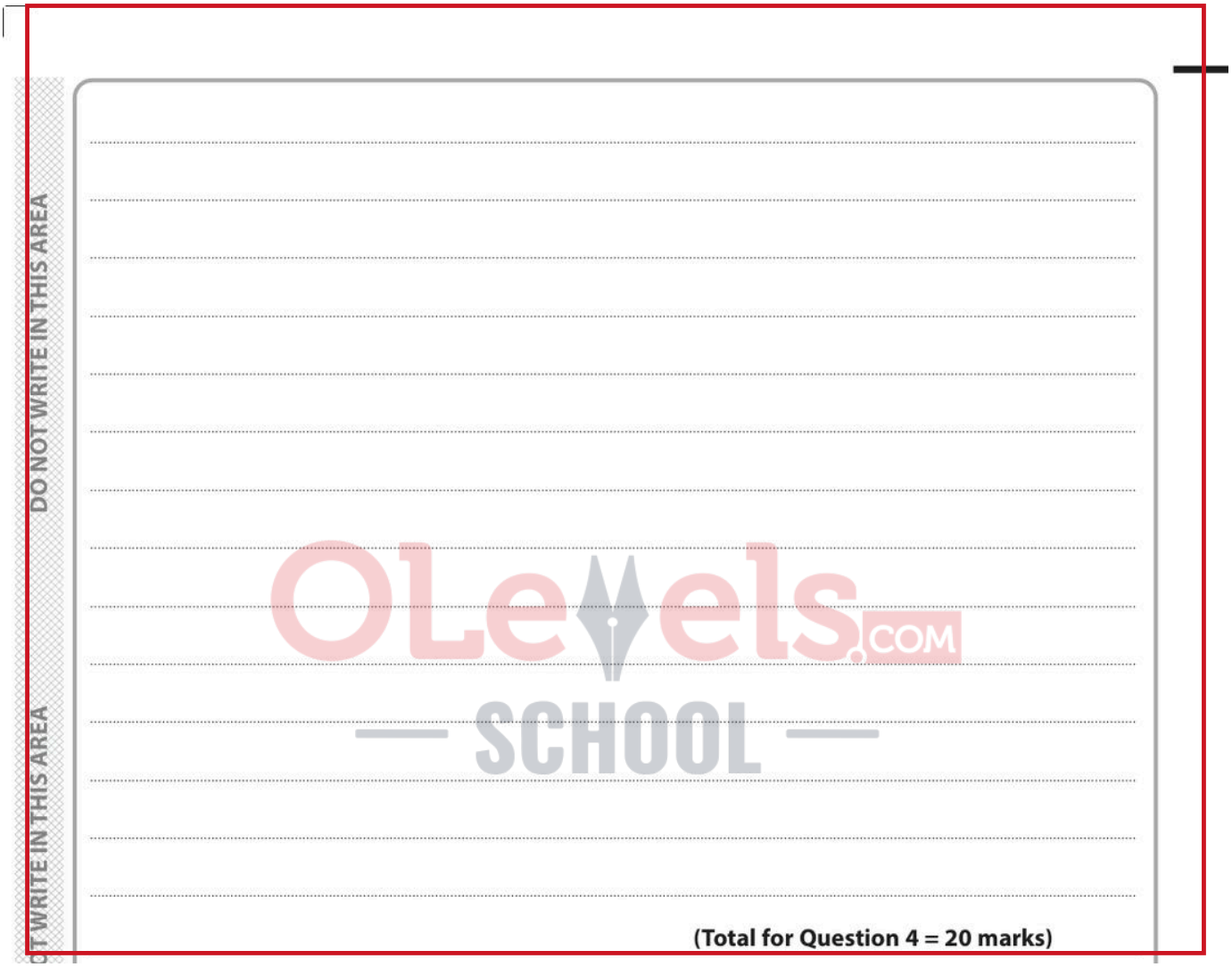
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15. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.



15. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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16. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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4 A *Yellow* T-shirt costs 11.05 Bangladeshi Taka (BDT) to manufacture. *Yellow* then sells them for 13.75 BDT.

(a) Calculate the gross profit for *Yellow* if it sold 14,000 T-shirts. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

BDT

Many customers of *Yellow* use social media.

(b) Analyse the disadvantage for *Yellow* of customers using social media.

(6)

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16. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

Yellow prides itself on using the following principles:

- sells a wide range of fashionable clothing
- limited advertising
- clothes are sold to a wide demographic
- clothes from suppliers are ready to go straight onto store shelves.

(c) Evaluate how *Yellow* may have gained a competitive advantage in the clothing market. You should use the information provided as well as your own knowledge of business.

(12)

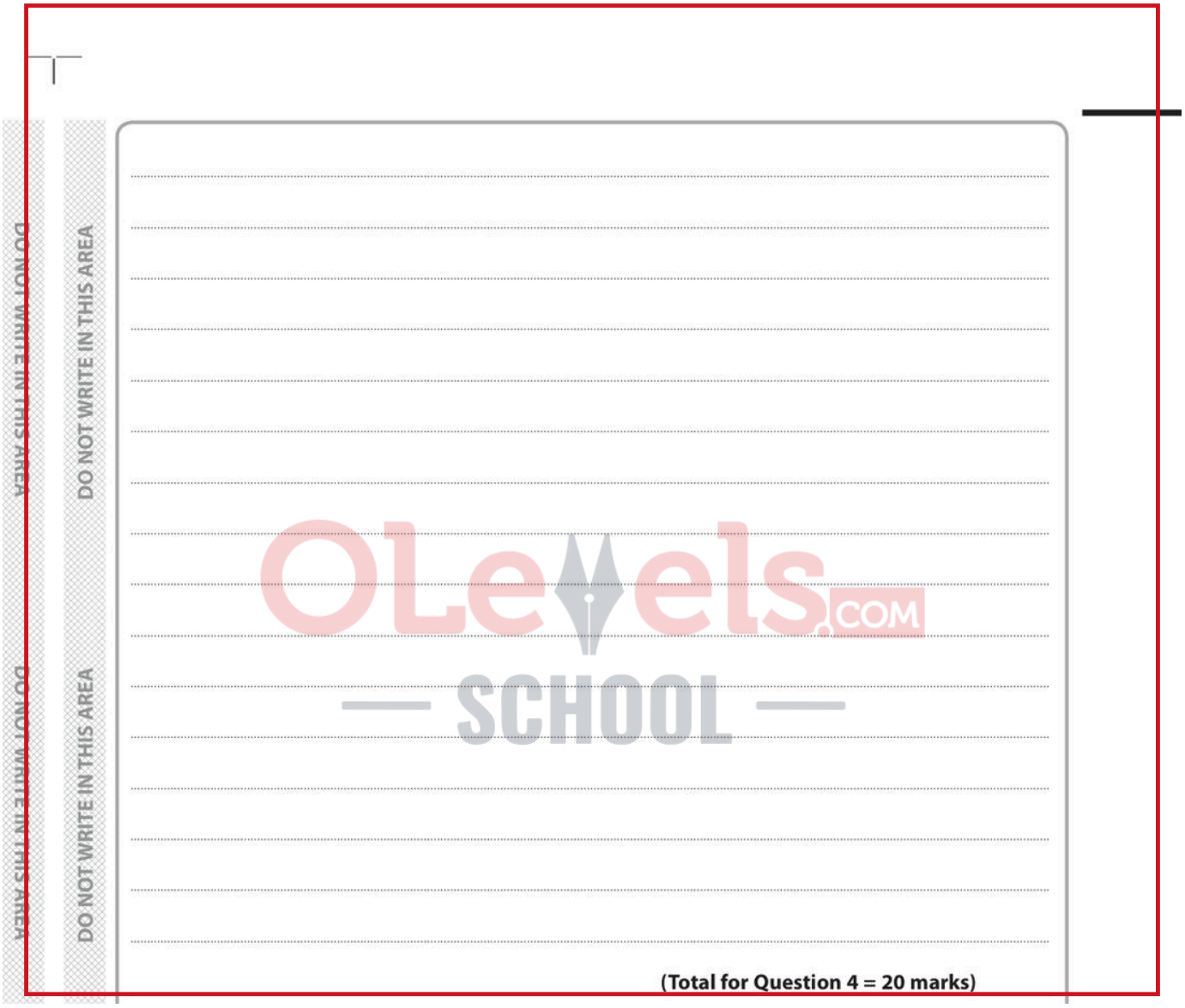
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16. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02 (regional R)

Further practice · Attempt part c only.



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16. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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17. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

4 In 2019 *LEGO* had current assets of 34 946 million DKK and current liabilities of 12 763 million DKK.

(a) Calculate, to two decimal places, the current ratio in 2019. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

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17. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

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Quality has always been one of *LEGO*'s main values. It wants everything that it makes and sells to be the best so its toys can help children learn and develop. It has a motto that 'only the best is good enough'. The founder of *LEGO* set a company rule that 'No one must be able to do this, better than us'. He also stated that he wanted 'only the best people that money could buy' to work at the business.

(b) Analyse the benefits to *LEGO* of increasing the use of robotics in the manufacture of toys and games.

(6)

OLevels.COM SCHOOL

17. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

LEGO has progressed from a small carpenter's shop to a global enterprise and has been named 'Toy of the Century' twice.

(c) Evaluate how *LEGO* has maintained a competitive advantage in the making of toys and games. You should use the information provided as well as your own knowledge of business.

(12)

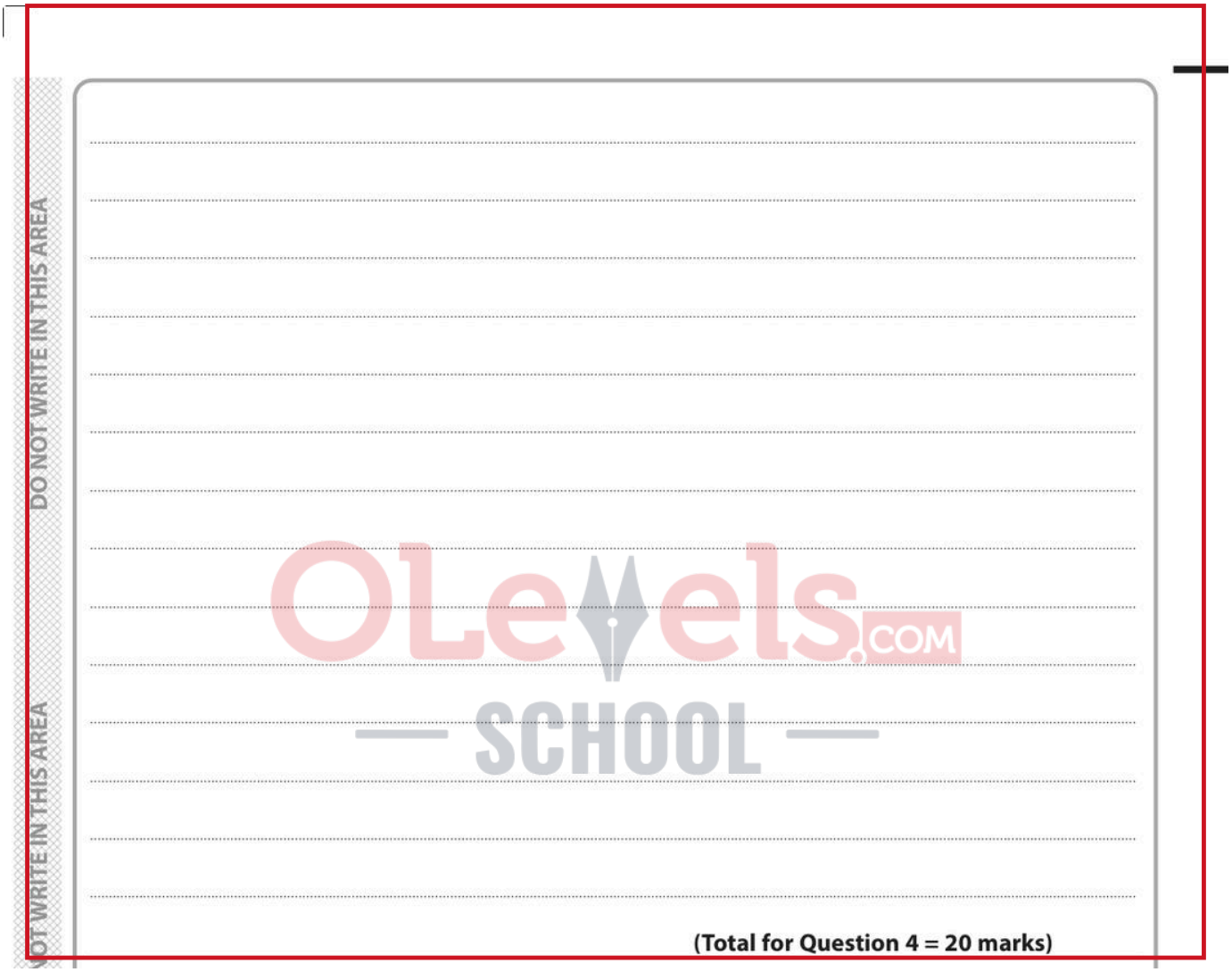
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17. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks

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17. Question 4 · part c · 12 marks · Working and answer

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